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Nature of Culture & Civilization

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Culture

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Meaning of Culture

- Popular meaning – polished behavior, a desirable quality, refinement, intellectual excellence etc.
- Anthropological Meaning – Nothing 'Uncultured'
- Because Culture is an attribute of genus homo – brain, hands etc. made it possible to have culture
- It rests on biology, but is not biological
- All have culture, some complex and some simple but nothing "uncultured"

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Importance of Culture

- Human Living – Impossible without a minimum of material objects
- Human Life – Impractical without a network of social relationships
- Human Existence – Unthinkable without ideas, rules, ideals and patterns of thinking

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Essence....

- These moral, material and mental aspects are integrated into a whole, to form a Design For Living
- This design for living is what we call **“Culture”**

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Nature of Culture

1. **Historically Created Design For Living**
   - Created 5 million years ago
   - But a little bit is added in every generation
   - It is cumulative
2. **Culture is Unique to Man**
   - Symbolism, language, moral and culture are unique to man
   - Learning and Sharing the learned experience
   - Complex cultural behavior is unique to man

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Nature of Culture

2. Culture is Non Genetic

- Learned, Shared
- Ex. Ants in a desert

3. Unity And Diversity

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Definitions

- Etymology – Latin – Colere – Tending or Cherish, Cultivate
- TYLOR – 'A complex whole which includes knowledge, art, belief, art, morals, law, custom and any other capabilities acquired by man as a member of a society'
- LINTON – 'The sum total of the knowledge, attitudes and habitual behavior patterns, shared and transmitted by the members of a particular society'

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Definitions

- MALINOWSKI – 'Handiwork of man and a medium through which he acquires his ends'
- HERSKOVITZ – 'Man made part of the environment'
- BIDNEY – 'Culture is a product of Agrifacts (products of civilization), Artifacts products of industry), Sociofacts (social organization) and Mentifacts (language, religion etc)

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Characteristics

1. Culture is Learned
2. Culture is inculcated – Transmitted
3. Culture is social
4. Culture is adaptive
5. Culture is gratifying
6. Culture is Structured
7. Culture is Integrative
8. Culture is ideational
9. Culture is Dynamic

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Attributes / Qualities

1. Overtness and Covertness
2. Explicit and Implicit
3. Ideality and Reality
4. Ethos and Eidos
5. Organic and Super Organic

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Attributes / Qualities

- Cultural Universals, Specialties and Alternatives
- Contra cultures and Sub cultures

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Cultural Processes

1. Evolution
2. Diffusion
3. Acculturation
4. Transculturation
5. Enculturation

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Functions

1. Culture makes man a human
2. Culture provides solutions for complicated situations
3. Culture provides traditional interpretations to certain situations
4. Culture keeps social relationships intact
5. Culture broadens the vision of individual
6. Culture creates and satisfies new needs

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Civilization

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Meaning of Civilization

- Culture – Material and Non Material
- **Ogburn and Nimkoff**
  - Civilization is the latter phase of super organic culture
- **Gillin and Gillin**
  - Ideas and techniques to develop and object is culture
  - The object itself is civilization

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Meaning of Civilization

- **McIver**
  - Civilization – utilitarian things
  - Material instruments which have been devised by man to control the conditions of life
- **A.W. Green**
  - A culture becomes a civilization only when it possesses written language, science, philosophy, a specialized DOL and a complex technological and political system
- **L.H. Morgan**
- Savagery – Barbarism - Civilization

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Difference between Culture & Civilization

1. Civilization has precise standard of measurement but not culture
2. Civilization is always advancing but not culture
3. Civilization is passed on without effort, but not culture

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Difference between Culture & Civilization

4. Civilization is borrowed without change or loss, but not culture
5. The work of civilization can be improved by anybody, but not in case of culture
6. Civilization is external and mechanical while culture is internal and organic

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Impact of Civilization on Culture

1. Civilization acts as a vehicle for culture
2. Civilization determines the degree to which our cultural activity is realized
3. The Products of civilization affect our culture

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Impact of Culture on Civilization

1. Culture influences direction and change of Civilization
2. Products of Civilization acquire cultural significance over a period of time

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